



AFP/Getty Images

UKRAINE STRIKES MOSCOW REFINERY

Volodymyr Zelensky again brought the war to the Russian capital with one of his biggest drone attacks. It came after he said he won further support from allies at this week’s Group of 7 summit. **WORLD, A2**

Justices uphold gun rights of drug users

Court says federal ban on access to firearms based on substance abuse is too harsh.

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court ruled for gun rights and against drug laws on Thursday, striking down part of a federal law that made it a crime for an “unlawful user” of an illegal drug such as marijuana to own firearms.

All nine justices agreed the law was too broad and overly harsh.

They left open the possibility that “addicts” and “unusually dangerous” people who were impaired by drugs could be denied guns.

The Trump administration had urged the court to uphold the prosecution of Ali Hemani, a Texas man who was investigated for alleged terrorist ties and admitted to being a regular user of marijuana.

Since 1968, federal law has prohibited gun possession by felons, fugitives and any other person who is “an unlawful user of or addicted to any controlled substance.”

In defense of the law, Solicitor Gen. D. John Sauer argued that “habitual” drug users were akin to “habitual drunkards” in early American history, and could therefore be denied the gun rights

[See Firearms, A6]

Noncitizen votes, LAPD oversight head to ballot

Expanding council is excluded from charter measure

By MELISSA GOMEZ, NOAH GOLDBERG AND DAVID ZAHNISER

Los Angeles voters will get a chance to approve a wide-ranging package of potential changes to the city charter — including giving the City Council the power to allow noncitizens to vote in city elections.

The noncitizen voting measure was part of a package of proposed city charter changes given preliminary approval by the City Council this week. The proposed charter revisions, which will be placed before voters on

the Nov. 3 ballot, also include a measure that would allow the council to set policy at the Los Angeles Police Department.

The proposal to allow noncitizens to vote was put forward by Councilmember Hugo Soto-Martínez and approved on a 10-5 vote at the council meeting Wednesday.

“I believe it’s a simple principle that should guide us: If you live in the city, contribute to the city, raise your family in the city and are impacted by the decisions made in the city, you deserve to have a voice in the city,” Soto-Martínez said.

At the same time, the council majority sidelined other measures that had been recommended by the Charter Reform Commission, including expansion of the City Council from 15 seats to 25 and a move to ranked-choice voting, in which voters list candidates in order of preference.

“I would have liked to have seen a more comprehensive charter review. But we are where we are,” Councilmember Tim McOsker said in an interview Wednesday evening.

Still, McOsker said that

[See Measures, A7]

Massive wind project is online

Largest such U.S. effort benefits California, others

By HAYLEY SMITH

The largest wind energy project in U.S. history is now online, delivering power from a massive array in New Mexico to Arizona and California — and signaling a new era for sending clean electricity across the West.

Nearly two decades in the making, the estimated \$11-billion SunZia project from Pattern Energy is now fully operational, company officials said Thursday. It’s made up of 916 turbines that can produce up to 3.65 gigawatts of electricity, making it potentially more powerful

than the Hoover Dam.

It’s also more than three times bigger than either of the next two largest U.S. wind farms, Alta Wind in Kern County and Great Prairie in northern Texas, according to the U.S. Energy Information Administration.

It’s a scale that would have been difficult to imagine even a decade ago.

Crucially, the project also includes a 550-mile high-voltage direct-current transmission line that delivers wind power from New Mexico to the Palo Verde substation in Arizona, where it then feeds into

Southern California. In all, some two-thirds of the power sent across the line will be delivered to the state.

Experts say the project already has begun making a difference on the grid: Since SunZia began testing in April, the state’s Independent System Operator, CAISO, has reported record-breaking amounts of wind power on the California grid at least five times, according to Dennis Warnsted, an energy analyst at the Institute for Energy Economics and Financial Analysis.

Wind output on May 15 hit a record 8,294 megawatts

[See SunZia, A8]

PACT: U.S. will pay firm \$765 million to end four offshore leases. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

World Cup turns Inglewood into global hub

It’s a boon for businesses as soccer fans from all over pour into the city



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

BARTENDER Elijah Gonzalez, left, prepares a drink at the Nile Bar in Inglewood while customers watch a World Cup soccer preview.

By JACK FLEMING

Daiki Kaneko had only 24 hours before his World Cup journey took him to Dallas, where his home country’s squad will take on Sweden.

The Japanese soccer fan was making the most of it on Tuesday in Inglewood, snapping pictures of SoFi Stadium before taking in a different kind of monument: a space-age, two-story branch of the chicken chain Raising Cane’s, complete with a 308-square-foot screen, a mirrored dog sculpture and a massive halo hovering around the exterior.

For Kaneko, 25, who lives in the Tokyo suburbs, it was the perfect encapsulation of American grandeur.

“All this for chicken,” he said. “I love America.”

Inglewood is already diverse — most residents are Latino or Black, and nearly a third are immigrants. But dur-

[See Inglewood, A6]

Concessions to Iran a reversal of U.S. policy

White House faces sharp, swift criticism over terms that GOP had long opposed.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — The White House pushed back Thursday against growing bipartisan criticism of a negotiated settlement to the war with Iran, arguing its concessions to the Islamic Republic were contingent on its conduct and essential to securing peace.

The administration’s defensive posture came as details of the framework agreement, known as a memorandum of understanding, were finally shared with the public, revealing a raft of compromises with Tehran long opposed by Republicans.

Vice President JD Vance, who helped negotiate the deal, told reporters Thursday that the deal was structured to reward Iran for good behavior. But the text of the agreement suggests otherwise.

The Trump administration agreed to release billions of dollars in Iranian as-

sets that were frozen and restricted by the United States “upon the implementation” of the memorandum — before any further actions are taken or additional negotiations begin. The president will issue sanctions waivers on Iranian oil, allowing Tehran to resume trading its most valuable export and breaking with decades of policy. And to facilitate that trade, boosting Tehran’s revenues, Trump agreed to immediately end a U.S. naval blockade of Iranian ports.

Still more concessions were offered to the Iranians, including a commitment by the U.S. administration to establish a fund of “at least \$300 billion for the reconstruction and economic development of the Islamic Republic” — in effect providing reparations for the war Trump started.

“All required licenses, waivers and permissions needed for the relevant financial transactions will be granted by the United States of America,” the memorandum reads.

Taken together, the document reads as a stunning reversal of U.S. policy toward Iran after decades

[See Iran, A6]

Hurdles lined up for billionaire tax

Though a 5% levy has tentatively qualified for California’s ballot, it could be derailed.

By QUEENIE WONG AND SEEMA MEHTA

A contentious proposal to tax California billionaires to alleviate federal healthcare cuts moved closer this week to landing on the November ballot, but efforts to defeat the measure before it reaches voters have already escalated.

The California secretary of state’s office said Wednesday that the proposal had enough valid signatures to be eligible for the Nov. 3 ballot. But discussions that have included the governor’s administration and lawmakers are underway about a potential deal that could prevent the initiative from being put in front of voters,

according to people familiar with the negotiations.

Supporters have until June 25 to withdraw the initiative or go forward with placing it on the ballot. The negotiations highlight the escalating debate surrounding the billionaire tax, an idea that has divided the Democratic Party and drawn fresh opposition from healthcare and education groups. The negotiations are in flux, and the outcome remains uncertain.

The initiative would impose a one-time tax of up to 5% on taxpayers and trusts with assets valued at more than \$1 billion, with some exceptions, such as property. The levy could be paid over five years. Ninety percent of the revenue would fund healthcare programs, and the remaining funds would be spent on food assistance and education programs. The proposal would cost the state’s richest residents

[See Tax, A7]



MUSTAFA HUSSAIN Bloomberg

OBAMA CENTER OPENS

At the uplifting event in Chicago, attended by three other ex-presidents, the current chief executive’s absence is conspicuous. **NATION, A4**

Ocean data system saved

Facing resistance, the Trump administration reverses a decision to yank a network of sensors. **CLIMATE, A9**

Weather
Turning sunny.
L.A. Basin: 75/60. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A13**

B-52 crash victims named

Families mourn the eight crew members killed in Monday’s crash. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

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